

Acknowledgments

I (RH) must begin with a note of gratitude to my wife, Rieky Keeris, who provided me with a happy environment and encouragement while writing this book.

I (PP) owe a debt of gratitude to my parents, my brother, Hari, and my sister-in-law, Devaki, for all their love and encouragement. They put up with my long periods of absence from family events as I worked on this book. I must also thank my brother for being my best friend and a constant source of support all my life.

We are happy to express our appreciation to Debby Hix for a career-long span of collegial interaction. We are also grateful for the long-term professional associations and friendships at Virginia Tech with Roger Ehrich, Bob and Bev Williges, Manuel A. Pérez-Quñones, Ed Fox, John Kelso, Sean Arthur, Mary Beth Rosson, and Joe Gabbard.

We are indebted to Brad Myers of Carnegie Mellon University for his support of this book from the start.

Special thanks to Akshay Sharma in the Virginia Tech Department of Industrial Design for giving us access to photograph the ideation studio and working environment there, including students at work and the sketches and prototypes they produced. And finally, our thanks for the many photographs and sketches provided by Akshay to include as figures in design chapters.

It is with pleasure we acknowledge the positive influence of Jim Foley, Dennis Wixon, and Ben Shneiderman, with whom our friendship goes back decades and transcends professional relationships.

We are grateful for the diligence and professionalism of the reviewers and editors for their valuable suggestions that have helped make the book much better.

I'll (RH) always be grateful for the warm welcome I received from Phil Gray and the people in the Department of Computing Science at the University of Glasgow who hosted my wonderful sabbatical in 1989. Special thanks to Steve Draper, Department of Psychology, University of Glasgow, for providing a comfortable and congenial place there to live.

Many thanks to Kim Gausepohl, who helped as a sounding board for ideas about integrating UX into real-world agile software environments. And we extend our appreciation to our long-time friend Mathew Mathai and others in

the Network Infrastructure and Services group in the IT organization at Virginia Tech. Mathew was instrumental in giving access to a real-world agile development environment and the invaluable learning experience that went with it.

Special thanks to Ame Wongsa for the many insightful conversations over the years about the nature of design, information architecture, and UX practice, and for providing us with the wireframes for the camping application example. We also thank Christina Janczak for providing us with the mood boards and other visual designs for this example, as well as the design for the book cover.

Finally, we are grateful for all the support from Nate McFadden and all the others at Morgan Kaufmann. It has been a pleasure to work with this organization.